

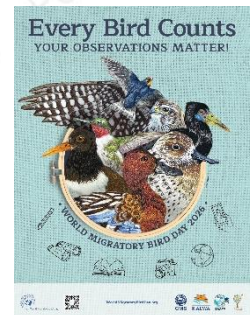
WEEKLY CA – 9th May – 15th May

1. World Migratory Bird Day is officially observed on:

विश्व प्रवासी पक्षी दिवस आधिकारिक तौर पर मनाया जाता है:

- A. First Saturday of May
- B. Second Saturday of May
- C. Third Sunday of May
- D. 9th May every year

Answer: B



9th May World Migratory Bird Day

- **Theme:** “Every Bird Counts – Your Observations Matter!”
- World Migratory Bird Day is officially celebrated on the second Saturday of May in Canada and the US, and the second Saturday of October in Mexico, Central and South America, and the Caribbean.

Date	Day	Theme
8 th – 9 th May	Time of Remembrance and Reconciliation (WWII)	
10 th May	World Lupus Day	Make Lupus Visible
10 th May	International Mother’s Day	
11 th May	National Technology Day	
12 th May	International Day of Plant Health	Plant Biosecurity for Food Security
12 th May	International Nurses Day	Our Nurses. Our Future. Empowered Nurses Save Lives.
15 th May	International Day of Families	Families, Inequalities and Child Wellbeing

2. Under the proposed “Viksit Bharat—Guarantee for Rozgar and Ajeevika Mission (Gramin)” (VB-G RAM G) programme, the statutory guarantee of wage employment to every rural household in a financial year is proposed to be:

प्रस्तावित “विकसित भारत—रोज़गार और आजीविका मिशन (ग्रामीण)” (VB-G RAM G) कार्यक्रम के तहत, किसी भी वित्तीय वर्ष में प्रत्येक ग्रामीण परिवार को मज़दूरी वाले रोज़गार की वैधानिक गारंटी इस प्रकार प्रस्तावित है:

- A. 100 days
- B. 125 days
- C. 150 days
- D. 200 days

Answer: B

End of an era: VB—G RAM G to replace MGNREGA on July 1 as Centre notifies rollout

- **The Viksit Bharat—Guarantee for Rozgar and Ajeevika Mission (Gramin): VB—G RAM G Act 2025**, which aims to repeal the Mahatma Gandhi National Rural Employment Guarantee Act (MGNREGA) 2005 and provides for a new rural job guarantee programme, will become effective on July 1, 2026.
- The **Union Ministry of Rural Development** issued a notification to this effect .
- **The more than two-decade-old MGNREGA, enacted by the UPA government, will thus cease to exist from July 1.**
- **VB G RAM G aims to provide a statutory guarantee of 125 days of wage employment in every financial year to every rural household** whose adult members volunteer for unskilled manual work, with the “objective to promote empowerment, growth, convergence and saturation for a prosperous and resilient rural Bharat”.
- Unlike the MGNREGS, where the Centre paid 100 per cent of the wage bill, VB G RAM G is a centrally sponsored scheme with a fund-sharing ratio of 60-40 between the Centre and states for all states, 90-10 for

Northeast states, Himalayan states, and Union Territories with a legislature, and 100 per cent central share for UTs without a legislature.

3. Sandbox technology developed during the Kakatiya era is primarily a:

काकतीय काल के दौरान विकसित सैंडबॉक्स तकनीक मुख्य रूप से एक है:

- A. Irrigation technique
- B. Geotechnical engineering technique
- C. Sculpture-making process
- D. Water harvesting method

Answer: B

Hanamkonda's Thousand Pillar Temple

- The Archaeological Survey of India (ASI) completed the 42-year-long restoration of the 12th-century dance pavilion (Kalyana Mandapam) at the Thousand Pillar Temple in Hanamkonda, Telangana.
- The structure, which had sunk into the ground due to foundational failure, was rebuilt piece-by-piece using indigenous Kakatiya-era sandbox technology.
- The Thousand Pillar Temple is an iconic 12th-century monument and a popular pilgrimage center.
- It is a Trikutalaya, dedicated to a troika of deities: Lord Shiva, Vishnu, and Surya Deva.
- Built By: Constructed in 1163 AD by the ruler Rudra Deva.



Key Characteristics:

- Depicts the **typical Chalukya style of architecture**.
- The temple features a **unique star-shaped architecture**, a testimony to the expertise of medieval craftsmen.
- Houses a **massive Nandi sculpture made of a single black basalt stone**, recently restored with a complete tail and folded leg.
- The temple is supported by richly carved pillars; it carries the name Thousand Pillar because many columns have vertical carvings that give the impression of multiple pillars.
- The dance pavilion was ransacked during the conquest of Ulugh Khan in 1323-24 and lay in ruins for centuries until this recent restoration.

Kakatiya-era Sandbox Technology:

- **Sandbox technology is an ancient geotechnical engineering technique where a building is constructed on a sand-filled pit rather than a conventional hard-rock foundation.**
- It was a unique architectural hallmark developed during the Kakatiya dynasty (12th–14th century) in Southern India.
- **A deep pit is dug where the foundation is to be laid.**
- **Binding Mixture:** The pit is filled with a mixture of sand, lime, jaggery (as a binder), and karakkaya (black myrobalan fruit).
- **Construction:** The heavy stone structure, including pillars and beams, is then raised on this sandbox.
- **The sandbox acts as a cushion; vibrations from earthquakes lose their intensity as they pass through the sand before reaching the building's foundation.**
- Laboratory experiments show that a sandbox can reduce the impact force of vibrations by nearly 60%.
- **Unlike modern rubber-based isolation techniques that wear out in 40 years, sand has a very slow weathering rate**, allowing monuments like the Thousand Pillar and Ramappa temples to last for hundreds of years.
- It is an **economical and environmentally sustainable technique as sand is naturally available.**
- While highly effective for shear-predominant structures common in India, it is not suitable for modern skyscrapers or extremely tall buildings.

4. Consider the following statements regarding the National Panchayat Awards 2025:

1. Andhra Pradesh secured the highest number of awards in 2025.
2. Financial incentives for winning Panchayats range from ₹50 lakh to ₹5 crore.

Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: B

National Panchayat Awards 2025 announced

- The government has announced the winners of the National Panchayat Awards 2025, with 42 Panchayats from across the country being selected for the honours.
- The Ministry of Panchayati Raj informed that the award distribution ceremony will be held in New Delhi on the 3rd of next month.
- Karnataka has secured the highest number of awards with six Panchayats being selected, followed by Andhra Pradesh and Odisha with five awards each.

The awards are being conferred under two categories –

- **The Deen Dayal Upadhyay awards recognise outstanding Gram Panchayats** for their performance across themes linked to Sustainable Development Goals, including poverty-free livelihoods, health, water sufficiency, sanitation, women-friendly governance and social justice.
 - A total of 34 Gram Panchayats from 17 States and Union Territories have been selected under this category.
- **Under the Nanaji Deshmukh Sarvottam Panchayat Satat Vikas Puraskar, awards will be given to the best-performing Panchayats at the district, block and gram levels.**
 - **Eight Panchayats have been selected** under this category, including three district Panchayats, two block Panchayats and three Gram Panchayats.
- **Further, the Ministry informed that the winning Panchayats will receive financial incentives ranging from 50 lakh rupees to five crore rupees, depending on the category and tier.**
- The awards are being given under the Incentivization of Panchayats scheme of the Rashtriya Gram Swaraj Abhiyan.
- **The Ministry of Panchayati Raj annually confers the National Panchayat Awards to recognize and incentivise best-performing Panchayats** and promote inclusive, participatory, and sustainable development in rural India.



Categories of Awards

Awards at National Level will be given to Gram, Block and District Panchayats under following categories namely:

1. Deen Dayal Upadhyay Panchayat Satat Vikas Puraskar
Top 3 GPs under each of 9 award themes
2. Nanaji Deshmukh Sarvottam Panchayat Satat Vikas Puraskar
For top 3 best GPs, BPs and DPs with highest average score under all themes combined
3. Atma Nirbhar Panchayat Special Award
For 3 GPs for their efforts towards mobilization and augmentation of Own Source of Revenue (OSR)
4. Climate Action Special Panchayat Award
For 3 GPs towards achieving Net-Zero carbon emissions and usage of renewable source of energy
5. Panchayat Kshemta Nirman Sarvottam Sanathan Puraskar
For 3 Institutions who has provided institutional support to GPs in achieving LSDGs
6. Nanaji Deshmukh Sarvottam Panchayat Satat Vikas Puraskar
One GP which qualifies and gets shortlisted for National Panchayat Awards during the subsequent years
7. Best Participant (State/District)
State/UT with highest percentage of participation from GPs (>60%)

Key Features

- Awards competition structure is now multi-level pyramidal at Block, District, State/UT and National Level.

All the Panchayats will be ranked based on their performance under each of the following 9 LSGD themes :

- Poverty free and enhanced livelihoods Panchayat
- Healthy Panchayat
- Child Friendly Panchayat
- Water Sufficient Panchayat
- Clean and Green Panchayat
- Self-sufficient infrastructure in Panchayat
- Socially Just and Socially secured Panchayat
- Panchayat with Good Governance
- Women-Friendly Panchayat

All the Gram Panchayats have to mandatorily fill the Questionnaires under all 9 award themes.

Deen Dayal Upadhyay Panchayat Satat Vikas Puraskar-2025					
Sl. No.	Award Theme/Category	State/UT	Rank	Name of Awardee Gram Panchayat (Block, District)	Prize Money (₹ Crore)
1	Poverty-Free & Enhanced Livelihoods Panchayat	Karnataka	1	Mudradi (Hebri, Udupi)	1.00
2	Poverty-Free & Enhanced Livelihoods Panchayat	Andhra Pradesh	2	Chemmulapalli (Khajipet, Y.S.R.)	0.75
3	Poverty-Free & Enhanced Livelihoods Panchayat	Sikkim	3	Gyalshing Omchung (Gyalshing)	0.50
4	Healthy Panchayat	Tripura	1	Kanchanbari (Kumarghat, Unakoti)	1.00
5	Healthy Panchayat	Karnataka	2	Vandse (Kundapura, Udupi)	0.75
6	Healthy Panchayat	Kerala	3	Niranam (Pulikeezhu, Pathanamthitta)	0.25
7	Healthy Panchayat	Odisha	3	Potalampur (Chatrapur, Ganjam)	0.25
8	Child-Friendly Panchayat	Maharashtra	1	Itgaon (Pu) (Bhandara, Bhandara)	1.00
9	Child-Friendly Panchayat	Karnataka	2	Halanayakanahalli (Bengaluru East, Bengaluru Urban)	0.75
10	Child-Friendly Panchayat	Kerala	3	Ottoor (Varkala, Thiruvananthapuram)	0.50
11	Water-Sufficient Panchayat	Maharashtra	1	Khariwali (Khalapur, Raigad)	1.00
12	Water-Sufficient Panchayat	Karnataka	2	Madamakki (Hebri, Udupi)	0.75
13	Water-Sufficient Panchayat	Odisha	3	Padua (Champua, Kendujhar)	0.50
14	Clean & Green Panchayat	Mizoram	1	Kawrthah North	1.00
15	Clean & Green Panchayat	Assam	2	Jumarmur (Kathiatoli, Nagaon)	0.375
16	Clean & Green Panchayat	Odisha	2	Hatibandha (Lathikata, Sundargarh)	0.375
17	Clean & Green Panchayat	Chhattisgarh	3	Sardih (Bagicha, Jashpur)	0.25
18	Clean & Green Panchayat	Himachal Pradesh	3	Lohardi (Balh, Mandi)	0.25
19	Self-Sufficient Infrastructure in Panchayat	Kerala	1	Melukavu (Erattupetta, Kottayam)	1.00
20	Self-Sufficient Infrastructure in Panchayat	Assam	2	Hoogrijan (Tengakhat, Dibrugarh)	0.75
21	Self-Sufficient Infrastructure in Panchayat	Andhra Pradesh	3	Gundamala (Kotha Patnam, Prakasam)	0.25
22	Self-Sufficient Infrastructure in Panchayat	Karnataka	3	Sanoor (Karkal, Udupi)	0.25
23	Socially Just & Socially Secured Panchayat	Himachal Pradesh	1	Shansha (Lahul, Lahaul and Spiti)	1.00
24	Socially Just & Socially Secured Panchayat	Maharashtra	2	Chambharli (Khalapur, Raigad)	0.375
25	Socially Just & Socially Secured Panchayat	Odisha	2	Mandar (Polosara, Ganjam)	0.375
26	Socially Just & Socially Secured Panchayat	Jammu & Kashmir	3	Wagoora (B.K. Pora, Budgam)	0.25
27	Socially Just & Socially Secured Panchayat	Karnataka	3	Hakladi (Kundapura, Udupi)	0.25
28	Panchayat with Good Governance	Andhra Pradesh	1	Srungavaram (Nathavaram, Visakhapatnam)	1.00
29	Panchayat with Good Governance	Maharashtra	2	Nimbale (Chandwad, Nashik)	0.75

30	Panchayat with Good Governance	Telangana	3	Mothukupalle (Kotepally, Vikarabad)	0.50
31	Women-Friendly Panchayat	Andhra Pradesh	1	Bokkasam Palem (Srikalahasti, Tirupati)	1.00
32	Women-Friendly Panchayat	Jharkhand	2	Jhikarhati East (Pakur, Pakur)	0.75
33	Women-Friendly Panchayat	Telangana	3	Fasalwadi (Sangareddy, Sangareddy)	0.25
34	Women-Friendly Panchayat	Tripura	3	Baikunthapur (Hezamara, West Tripura)	0.25

Nanaji Deshmukh Sarvottam Panchayat Satat Vikas Puraskar-2025

Sl. No.	Award Theme/Category	State/UT	Rank	Name of Awardee Panchayat	Prize Money (₹ Crore)
35	Best District Panchayat	Tripura	1	Sepahijala	5.00
36	Best District Panchayat	Odisha	2	Ganjam	3.00
37	Best District Panchayat	Tamil Nadu	3	Coimbatore	2.00
38	Best Block Panchayat	Kerala	1	Harippad (Alappuzha)	2.00
39	Best Block Panchayat	Andhra Pradesh	3	Kuppam (Chittoor)	1.50
40	Best Gram Panchayat	Assam	1	New Napam (Gabhoru, Sonitpur)	1.50
41	Best Gram Panchayat	Bihar	2	Telcup (Rohtas, Rohtas)	1.25
42	Best Gram Panchayat	Uttar Pradesh	3	Biraharu (Saiyan, Agra)	1.00

5. Kartavya-KAAMS, recently launched in Karnataka, is an:

हाल ही में कर्नाटक में शुरू किया गया कर्तव्य-काम एक :

- A. AI and GIS-enabled facial recognition attendance system
- B. blockchain-based taxation platform
- C. satellite-based disaster monitoring network
- D. digital agricultural marketplace

Answer: A

AI, GIS-enabled Kartavya-KAAMS app launched for attendance of school teachers, staff

- The Department of School Education and Literacy (DSEL) has launched the 'Karnataka Advanced Attendance Management System (Kartavya-KAAMS) to identify and monitor the attendance of permanent teaching and non-teaching staff and officers.
- The Kartavya-KAAMS is an artificial intelligence (AI) and geographic information system (GIS) enabled facial recognition mobile app.
- It is mandatory for teaching and non-teaching staff to register attendance twice a day on the app from the place where they are on duty from the academic year 2026-27.

6. Who has been appointed as the next Flag Officer Commanding-in-Chief of the Western Naval Command?

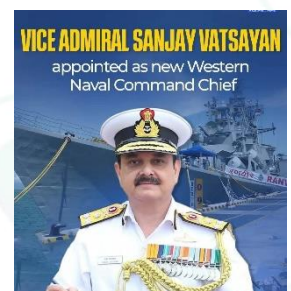
पश्चिमी नौसेना कमान के अगले फ्लैग ऑफिसर कमांडिंग-इन-चीफ के रूप में किसे नियुक्त किया गया है?

- A. Admiral Dinesh K Tripathi
- B. Vice Admiral Sanjay Vatsayan
- C. Vice Admiral Krishna Swaminathan
- D. Admiral R Hari Kumar

Answer: B

Vice Admiral Sanjay Vatsayan appointed as new Western Naval Command Chief

- Vice Admiral Sanjay Vatsayan has been appointed as the next Flag Officer Commanding-in-Chief of the Western Naval Command, headquartered in Mumbai.



- He is currently serving as the Vice Chief of Naval Staff
- A specialist in Gunnery and Missile Systems, Vice Admiral Vatsayan was commissioned into the Indian Navy in 1988
- He was awarded the Ati Vishisht Seva Medal in 2021 in recognition of his distinguished service.

7. Under the proposed Annapurna Bhandar scheme, eligible women are expected to receive:

प्रस्तावित 'अन्नपूर्णा भंडार योजना' के तहत, पात्र महिलाओं को निम्नलिखित प्राप्त होने की उम्मीद है:

- A. ₹1,500 per month
- B. ₹1,700 per month
- C. ₹2,500 per month
- D. ₹3,000 per month

Answer: D

Annapurna Bhandar Scheme Announced in West Bengal

- West Bengal announced the proposed Annapurna Bhandar scheme on 11 May 2026 after the first cabinet meeting of the new BJP government.
- The scheme is linked to financial support for eligible women in the state and is scheduled for rollout from 1 June 2026.
- The Annapurna Bhandar scheme is a state welfare initiative for women in West Bengal.
- Eligible women are expected to receive Rs 3,000 per month through direct bank transfers.
- The scheme has been described as a replacement or major upgrade to the earlier Lakshmir Bhandar scheme.

Lakshmir Bhandar Scheme

- Lakshmir Bhandar was a women-centric welfare scheme in West Bengal.
- It provided Rs 1,500 per month to general category women and Rs 1,700 per month to Scheduled Caste and Scheduled Tribe beneficiaries.
- The new proposal places Annapurna Bhandar in the same policy area of direct cash support to women.



8. The primary objective of the "One Case One Data" initiative is to:

“One Case One Data” पहल का मुख्य उद्देश्य है:

- A. Strengthen judicial data integration across courts
- B. Digitize prison administration records
- C. Establish fast-track courts in every district
- D. Introduce AI judges in subordinate courts

Answer: A

CJI Surya Kant announces 'One Case One Data' initiative, launches AI chatbot 'Su Sahay'

- Chief Justice of India Surya Kant announced the launch of a major digital initiative aimed at strengthening judicial data integration and improving public access to court services across the country.
- The "One Case One Data" initiative, will integrate multi-level information from all the high courts, district courts, and taluka courts into a unified system.
- the 'one case one data' initiative with multi-level information of all high courts, district and taluka court details embedded.
- The CJI also announced the launch of "Su Sahay", an Artificial Intelligence-powered assistance chatbot integrated with the Supreme Court website to facilitate easier access to justice and court-related services for litigants.
- The chatbot has been developed by the National Informatics Centre (NIC) in collaboration with the Supreme Court Registry.
- This will provide a simple and convenient interface for citizens to seek front-end guidelines and guidance in accessing essential services of the Supreme Court

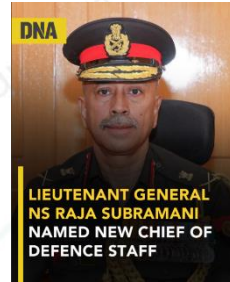


9. Who has been appointed as the new Chief of Defence Staff (CDS) of India?

भारत के नए चीफ ऑफ डिफेंस स्टाफ (CDS) के रूप में किसे नियुक्त किया गया है?

- A. General Anil Chauhan
- B. Lieutenant General NS Raja Subramani
- C. General Manoj Pande
- D. Admiral Dinesh Kumar Tripathi

Answer: B



- Lieutenant General NS Raja Subramani (Retd) appointed as Chief of Defence Staff
- The Government of India has appointed Lieutenant General **NS Raja Subramani as the new Chief of Defence Staff (CDS). He will succeed General Anil Chauhan after the latter completes his tenure on 30 May 2026.**
- Lieutenant General NS Raja Subramani is a retired senior officer of the Indian Army appointed as India's new Chief of Defence Staff (CDS).
- **He is currently serving as the Military Adviser in the National Security Council Secretariat (NSCS) since September 2025.**
- Commissioned into the 8th Battalion of the Garhwal Rifles on 14 December 1985.

The Chief of Defence Staff is the highest-ranking military officer in India who acts as:

- Principal Military Adviser to the Defence Minister on tri-services matters
- Permanent Chairman of the Chiefs of Staff Committee (COSC)
- Secretary of the Department of Military Affairs (DMA)
- **The CDS promotes jointness, integration and coordination among the Army, Navy and Air Force.**
- The post of CDS was officially created on 24 December 2019 by the Cabinet Committee on Security (CCS).
- General Bipin Rawat became India's first CDS on 31 December 2019.
- After the Kargil War, the Kargil Review Committee headed by K Subrahmanyam recommended comprehensive reforms in India's defence management system in 1999.
- The Group of Ministers (GoM) in 2001 also recommended creation of the CDS post.
- Permanent Chairman of COSC: CDS serves as the Permanent Chairman of the Chiefs of Staff Committee.
- Head of Department of Military Affairs: CDS functions as Secretary of the DMA within the Ministry of Defence.
- Facilitates integrated planning, operations, logistics and procurement among the three services.
- **CDS is responsible for progressing towards integrated Theatre Commands for unified warfighting.**

10. The one-member inquiry commission into the Bargi Dam cruise accident is headed by:

बरगी बांध क्रूज़ दुर्घटना की एक-सदस्यीय जाँच समिति की अध्यक्षता किसके द्वारा की जा रही है?

- A. Justice Ranjan Gogoi
- B. Justice Sanjay Dwivedi
- C. Justice A.K. Sikri
- D. Justice U.U. Lalit

Answer: B.

Madhya Pradesh: One-member commission set up to investigate Bargi Dam cruise tragedy

- The Madhya Pradesh government has set up a one-member inquiry commission **headed by retired High Court judge Sanjay Dwivedi to conduct a judicial investigation into the Bargi Dam cruise accident that took place on April 30 in Jabalpur.**
- The commission will submit its report to the government within three months.
- It will examine the causes of the accident and whether the rescue operations were carried out properly.

11. The Jute Crop Information System (JCIS) has been developed in collaboration with:

जूट फसल सूचना प्रणाली (JCIS) को इनके सहयोग से विकसित किया गया है:

- (a) Defence Research and Development Organisation (DRDO)
- (b) Indian Space Research Organisation (ISRO)

(c) Council of Scientific and Industrial Research (CSIR)

(d) Indian Council of Agricultural Research (ICAR)

Answer: (b)

The National Jute Board (NJB)

- The National Jute Board has expanded the implementation of the Jute Crop Information System (JCIS), a technology-driven platform developed with ISRO to modernize crop monitoring.
- The National Jute Board is the apex body under the Ministry of Textiles, Government of India, responsible for the overall development of the jute sector.
- Established In: The board is governed by the National Jute Board Act, 2008, and was formally enacted on February 12, 2009.

Aim:

- To increase the global share of Indian jute goods by exploring innovative uses and disseminating new technologies.
- To facilitate the growth of the jute industry through human resource development, training, and design inputs.
- About Jute Crop Information System (JCIS):
- The Jute Crop Information System (JCIS) is a state-of-the-art digital platform developed in collaboration with the Indian Space Research Organisation (ISRO) and the Jute Corporation of India (JCI).
- It replaces manual, fragmented reporting with a geo-referenced, evidence-based monitoring framework.
- The system aims to improve the accuracy of jute crop area, yield, and production estimates through a data-driven approach, enabling targeted policy interventions and rapid response to environmental stresses.
- Uses ISRO's satellite data and vegetation indices to monitor the health and extent of jute cultivation across districts.

Digital Tools:

- **BHUVAN JUMP:** A mobile application used by the I-CARE field network for large-scale collection of geo-tagged field data.
- **PATSAN:** A web-based analytics platform that provides surveillance and production assessments for stakeholders and government officials.

12. 'Achal' belongs to which class of fast patrol vessels?

‘अचल’ फास्ट पेट्रोल वेसल्स की किस श्रेणी से संबंधित है?

- A. Vikram-class
- B. Samarth-class
- C. Adamy-class
- D. Sankalp-class

Answer: C.

Indian Coast Guard Commissions ICGS Achal at Goa Shipyard Limited

- Fast Patrol Vessel (FPV) 'Achal' was commissioned into the Indian Coast Guard, bolstering the maritime force's operational capabilities
- **'Achal' is the fifth one in a series of eight FPVs being constructed by Goa Shipyard Ltd (GSL) for the coast guard.**
- The new-generation **Adamy-class fast patrol vessel** was commissioned into the ICG at Goa Shipyard Limited,
- **The ship will be stationed at Vadinar, Gujarat, operating under the administrative and operational control of the Commander, Coast Guard Region (North West)**
- **The vessel will undertake a wide range of missions, including surveillance, interdiction, Search and Rescue (SAR), anti-smuggling operations, and pollution response, reinforcing the Indian Coast Guard's role in safeguarding India's eastern maritime frontier.**
- **'Achal', meaning 'firm', embodies the coast guard's steadfast commitment. "It signifies our resolve to protect life at sea and secure our maritime frontiers.**



- **Powered by two 3000 kW** advanced diesel engines, the vessel delivers a top speed of 27 knots and an operational endurance of 1500 nautical miles, enabling extended missions in India's maritime zones,

13. The Aftercare Scheme for Young Persons will be implemented under which Act?

युवा व्यक्तियों के लिए 'आफ्टरकेयर योजना' किस अधिनियम के तहत लागू की जाएगी?

- Protection of Children from Sexual Offences Act, 2012
- Child Labour (Prohibition and Regulation) Act, 1986
- Juvenile Justice (Care and Protection of Children) Act, 2015
- Right of Children to Free and Compulsory Education Act, 2009

Answer: C

Delhi Launches Aftercare Scheme for Young Persons

- Chief Minister Rekha Gupta launched the Aftercare Scheme for Young Persons to provide continued support to youth leaving institutional care after they turn 18 by assisting them with higher education, skill development, and employment opportunities.
- The primary objective of the scheme is to provide continued support, guidance and opportunities to youth leaving institutional care so they can move towards independent, secure and dignified lives.
- The scheme will be implemented under the Juvenile Justice (Care and Protection of Children) Act, 2015.



14. Consider the following statements regarding the Central Bureau of Investigation (CBI):

1. The CBI Director is appointed by the Central Government on the recommendation of a three-member committee.
2. The Leader of Opposition in the Rajya Sabha is a member of the selection committee for appointment of the CBI Director.
3. The CBI derives its powers from the Delhi Special Police Establishment Act, 1946.

Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 and 3 only
- (b) 1 only
- (c) 2 and 3 only
- (d) 1, 2 and 3

Answer: a

Praveen Sood gets one-year extension as CBI Director

- The Central Bureau of Investigation (CBI) Director, Praveen Sood, has been given another one-year extension, as approved by the Appointments Committee of the Cabinet (ACC) based on the recommendations of the Selection Committee.
- The 1986-batch Indian Police Service (IPS) officer was earlier granted one-year extension in May 2025 after completion of his two-year term as CBI chief.

Appointment Process

- As per the Delhi Special Police Establishment (DSPE) Act 1946, the CBI Director is appointed by the Central Government on the recommendation of a 3-members committee consisting of
 - Prime Minister (Chairperson)
 - Chief Justice of India (or Judge of the Supreme Court nominated by him)
 - Leader of Opposition in Lok Sabha (or the leader of the single largest opposition party in Lok Sabha).
- **Tenure:** 2 years, extendable to 3 more years (1 year at a time).
- The establishment of the CBI was recommended by the Santhanam Committee on Prevention of Corruption (1962–1964).
- The CBI is not a statutory body. It derives its powers from the Delhi Special Police Establishment Act, 1946.



15. Consider the following statements regarding Section 18 of the SC/ST (Prevention of Atrocities) Act, 1989:

It excludes the application of anticipatory bail in cases where the Act is attracted.

It is related to preventive detention provisions.

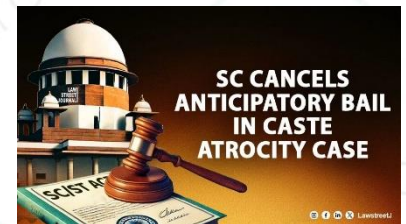
Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: A

Supreme Court on SC/ST Act Bail Bar

- The Supreme Court in May 2026 held that the statutory bar under Section 18 of the Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes (Prevention of Atrocities) Act, 1989, cannot be applied mechanically to deny anticipatory bail.
- The Supreme Court of India has held that courts cannot mechanically reject anticipatory bail pleas merely because provisions of the Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes (Prevention of Atrocities) Act have been invoked.
- The Court stated that judges must examine the FIR, the supporting material, and the nature of allegations before deciding whether a prima facie offence under the Act exists.
- Section 18 of the Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes (Prevention of Atrocities) Act, 1989, excludes the application of Section 438 of the Code of Criminal Procedure, 1973, in cases where the Act is attracted.
- Anticipatory bail is a pre-arrest legal remedy under Section 438 of the Code of Criminal Procedure, 1973.



16. The galaxy "Loki" is believed to have been a:

माना जाता है कि आकाशगंगा "लोकी" एक:

- (a) Spiral galaxy
- (b) Elliptical galaxy
- (c) Ring galaxy
- (d) Dwarf galaxy

Answer: (d)

Scientists Find Possible Dwarf Galaxy Inside Milky Way

- Scientists have discovered new clues suggesting that the Milky Way grew larger billions of years ago by absorbing a smaller dwarf galaxy.
- The findings, published in the journal Monthly Notices of the Royal Astronomical Society, indicate that remnants of this ancient galaxy may still exist inside our own.
- Researchers have named the dwarf galaxy "Loki," after the Norse god of trickery.
- The study suggests that the Milky Way expanded over time by merging with smaller star systems and dwarf galaxies. Loki is believed to have been one such dwarf galaxy made up of billions of stars.
- The discovery was made after scientists examined 20 metal-poor stars located on the Milky Way's galactic plane, the flat region where most of the galaxy's stars are found.
- Metal-poor stars are considered extremely old and are believed to preserve chemical details from the environments in which they originally formed.

17. The Air Cushion Vehicles (ACVs) for the Indian Coast Guard are being built at:

भारतीय तटरक्षक बल के लिए एयर कुशन वाहन (ACVs) यहाँ बनाए जा रहे हैं:

- (a) Mazagon Dock Shipbuilders
- (b) Garden Reach Shipbuilders & Engineers
- (c) Chowgule Shipyard
- (d) Cochin Shipyard

Answer: (c)

Indian Coast Guard Holds ACV Girder-Laying Ceremony in Goa

- The Indian Coast Guard conducted the girder laying ceremony for the fourth, fifth and sixth Air Cushion Vehicles (ACVs) being built for the force at the Rassaim Yard of Chowgule Shipyard in Goa.
- The ACVs are being manufactured under the Centre's Aatmanirbhar Bharat initiative with around 50 per cent indigenous content.
- The contract for six indigenously designed and constructed ACVs was signed between the Coast Guard and Chowgule & Company Private Limited in October 2024.
- According to the ministry, the modern air cushion vehicles will be used for multiple maritime operations, including high-speed coastal patrolling, reconnaissance in shallow waters and marshy terrain, deep-sea operations, interception and interdiction missions, and search and rescue activities.
- The vessels are also expected to assist ships and boats in distress and enhance the Coast Guard's operational capabilities across India's coastal areas.

Indian Coast Guard
@IndianCoastGuard

Girder Laying Ceremony for the 4th, 5th & 6th indigenously built Air Cushion Vehicles (ACVs) of @IndianCoastGuard was held today at Chowgule's Rassaim Yard, #Goa, in the presence of Chief Staff Officer (Tech), #ICG Regional HQ (West). The contract for six #ACVs, signed with #MoD on 24 Oct 2024, marks a major milestone under #AatmanirbharBharat, strengthening #India's path to self-reliance in advanced maritime platforms. Built with over 50% indigenous content, these state-of-the-art hovercraft will boost #MaritimeSecurity, enhance rapid response & operational agility across India's vast coastline.
@ChowguleG



18. Who is the Chairperson of the Judicial Infrastructure Advisory Committee?

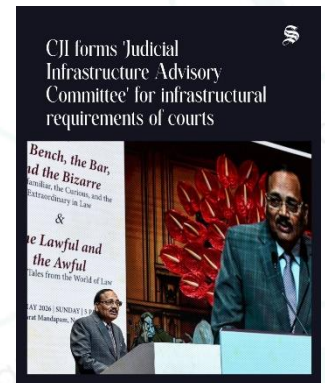
न्यायिक अवसंरचना सलाहकार समिति के अध्यक्ष कौन हैं?

- (a) Justice Surya Kant
- (b) Justice Aravind Kumar
- (c) Justice B.R. Gavai
- (d) Justice Sanjiv Khanna

Answer: (b)

The Justice Aravind Kumar Committee

- Chief Justice of India Surya Kant has constituted a high-powered 'Judicial Infrastructure Advisory Committee' headed by Supreme Court Justice Aravind Kumar.
- The Judicial Infrastructure Advisory Committee is a high-level expert panel formed to overhaul the physical and digital landscape of the Indian judiciary.
- It comprises senior judges from the Supreme Court and various High Courts, along with top administrative and technical officials.
- **Established By:** Supreme Court of India
- The primary aim of the committee is to address chronic infrastructural gaps in the Indian court system by creating a comprehensive roadmap for the 21st century.
- It seeks to ensure substantial financial backing from the Government of India to transform courts into modern, tech-enabled, and litigant-friendly spaces.
- A core focus is on the e-courts initiative, aimed at bridging the digital divide through robust virtual and hybrid hearing infrastructure.



19. Consider the following statements regarding the Scheme for Promotion of Surface Coal/Lignite Gasification Projects:

The scheme provides a maximum financial incentive of 20% of the cost of Plant and Machinery.

The scheme is limited only to indigenous technologies.

Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 2 only
- (c) Both 1 and 2
- (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: (a)

Cabinet approves Scheme for Promotion of Surface Coal/Lignite Gasification Projects

- The Union Cabinet chaired by the Prime Minister Shri Narendra Modi has approved a Scheme for Promotion of Surface Coal/Lignite Gasification Projects with a financial outlay of Rs.37,500 crore.
- The Scheme marks a major step towards accelerating India's coal/lignite gasification programme, advancing the national target of gasifying 100 Million Tonnes (MT) of coal by 2030.
- The Government has also extended coal linkage tenure up to 30 years under the "Production of Syngas leading to Coal Gasification" sub-sector in the Non-Regulated Sector (NRS) linkage auction framework.



Salient Features of the Scheme:

- Financial incentive provided at a maximum of 20% of the cost of Plant and Machinery.
- Selection through a transparent and competitive bidding process, with an evaluation framework benchmarking project cost, coal input, and syngas output.
- Incentive under this Scheme is in addition to, and does not restrict access to, incentives under the commercial coal mining regime or schemes of other Central/State Government ministries.

Strategic and Economic Benefits:

- Expected Investment Mobilisation: Rs.2.5- 3.0 lakh crore
- Energy Security & Import Substitution: Diversified use of coal resources and substitutes imports of LNG, urea, ammonia, ammonium nitrate, methanol, and coking coal.
- The Scheme is projected to create around 50,000 (Direct + Indirect) jobs across 25 projects in coal-bearing regions.
- Coal/lignite utilization is expected to generate Rs.6,300 crore annually from 75 Million Tonne of gasification envisaged under the Scheme, plus downstream revenue from GST and other levies.

20. The intercontinental ballistic missile Sarmat, known by NATO as "SS-29 Satan II", belongs to which country?

इंटरकॉन्टिनेंटल बैलिस्टिक मिसाइल 'सरमत', जिसे NATO द्वारा "SS-29 Satan II" के नाम से जाना जाता है, किस देश की है?

- (a) China
- (b) United States
- (c) Russia
- (d) France

Answer: (c)

Russia Tests Sarmat Nuclear Missile

- Russia conducted a test launch of the Sarmat super-heavy intercontinental ballistic missile from the Plesetsk Cosmodrome in the Arkhangelsk region.
- The Sarmat is a liquid-fuelled intercontinental ballistic missile
- It is known to NATO as SS-29 Satan II and is intended to replace the Soviet-era R-36M2 Voyevoda, which NATO designated as SS-18 Satan.
- The missile is designed to carry multiple nuclear warheads and to penetrate missile defence systems.
- Sarmat was capable of suborbital flight, giving it a range exceeding 35,000km (21,750 miles),



21. Under the Public Examinations (Prevention of Unfair Means) Act, 2024, organized paper leaks may attract imprisonment of:

सार्वजनिक परीक्षा (अनुचित साधनों की रोकथाम) अधिनियम, 2024 के तहत, संगठित रूप से पेपर लीक करने पर कितने समय तक की कारावास हो सकती है?

- (a) 1 to 5 years

- (b) 2 to 7 years
(c) 3 to 10 years
(d) 5 to 14 years

Answer: (c)

NEET 2026 Paper Leak

- The National Testing Agency (NTA) announced a re-test for NEET-UG 2026 after admitting that the examination process had been compromised amid allegations of a large-scale paper leak.
- The 2026 NEET-UG crisis represents a systemic failure in the high-stakes examination framework of India.
- It highlights the inability of the National Testing Agency (NTA) to secure confidential materials, leading to a breakdown of student trust and a chequered past of recurring leaks, rank inflation, and administrative lapses that threaten the meritocratic basis of medical admissions.



Government Laws to Prevent Paper Leaks:

- To combat this, the government enacted the Public Examinations (Prevention of Unfair Means) Act, 2024:
- Provides for imprisonment of 3 to 10 years and fines up to ₹1 crore for organized paper leaks.
- Includes provisions to bar and fine service providers (exam centers) found involved in malpractices.
- Makes offenses related to paper leaks cognizable and non-bailable.
- Mandates a Zero Tolerance policy and the use of high-sensitivity technical equipment for surveillance.

About K. Radhakrishnan Committee Recommendations:

- Transition to CBT: Shift the exam from Pen-and-Paper to a Computer-Based Test (CBT) format to eliminate physical booklet leaks.
- Implement Computer-assisted Secure PPT where encrypted papers are sent digitally and printed locally just before the exam.
- Significantly increase the number of state-of-the-art computer labs and testing centers across India.
- Consider conducting NEET in multiple sessions or stages to reduce the pressure and risk associated with a single-day event.
- Conduct regular third-party audits of the testing software, storage protocols, and personnel involved in the examination chain.

22. What is the IUCN conservation status of the forest owl?

वन उल्लू की IUCN संरक्षण स्थिति क्या है?

- A. Endangered
B. Near Threatened
C. Vulnerable
D. Critically Endangered

Answer: A

Forest Owlet

- Recently, in Kuno National Park in Madhya Pradesh forest owl has been spotted 113 years after it was last seen.
- It is a member of the typical owl family, Strigidae.
- It was first described in 1873. As it was not sighted after 1884, it was considered extinct for many years. In 1997, it was rediscovered.
- It is mainly found in tropical and subtropical moist lowland woods, dense deciduous woodlands, open dry deciduous teak woods, and tropical and subtropical dry forests.
- It is endemic to the forests of central India.
- It was observed in Odisha, Chhattisgarh, Madhya Pradesh, Maharashtra, and Gujarat, and at a few locations in the Melghat Tiger Reserve in Maharashtra.
- Conservation Status
- IUCN Red List: Endangered



- CITES: Appendix I.
- Features of Forest Owlet
- It is a typical owlet with a rather unspotted crown, presence of full throat collar, thickly feathered legs, heavily banded wings, and a tail.
- These birds are diurnal and have been observed to hunt during the day.
- They eat rodents, reptiles such as lizards and skinks, and insects.

23. TARA is India's first indigenous:

TARA भारत का पहला स्वदेशी है:

- A. Glide weapon system
- B. Ballistic missile system
- C. Anti-submarine drone
- D. Hypersonic interceptor

Answer: a

- The Tactical Advanced Range Augmentation (TARA) Weapon
- The DRDO and the Indian Air Force (IAF) successfully conducted the maiden flight-trial of the Tactical Advanced Range Augmentation (TARA) weapon off the coast of Odisha.
- TARA is a modular range extension kit and India's first indigenous glide weapon system.
- It is designed to be fitted onto existing unguided warheads, converting them into advanced precision-guided weapons.
- **Developed By:** Research Centre Imarat (RCI), Hyderabad.
- **Aim:** The primary objective of TARA is to provide a low-cost solution to enhance the lethality and accuracy of existing unguided munitions. It is specifically designed to neutralize ground-based targets with high precision, reducing collateral damage and improving mission success rates.



Key Features:

- First weapon system of its kind developed entirely within India to provide gliding capabilities to traditional bombs.
- Features a kit that can be easily integrated with a variety of unguided warheads.
- Built using low-cost systems to ensure that advanced precision capabilities can be deployed at scale without prohibitive expenses.

24. Consider the following statements regarding LEADS 2025:

West Bengal was categorized as a High Performer among Coastal States.

Madhya Pradesh was categorized as an Accelerator among Landlocked States.

Arunachal Pradesh was categorized as an Accelerator among North-Eastern States.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 2 and 3 only
- (b) 1 and 2 only
- (c) 1 and 3 only
- (d) 1, 2 and 3

Answer: (a)

LEADS 2025 Report

- Union Minister of India released the LEADS 2025 Report and felicitated the winners of the LEAPS 2025 Awards in New Delhi.
- LEADS (Logistics Ease Across Different States) is the flagship annual assessment and benchmarking tool for India's logistics sector.
- It evaluates the logistics ecosystem of each State and Union Territory (UT) across various parameters like infrastructure, services, and regulatory environment.



- Published By: Department for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade (DPIIT), Ministry of Commerce & Industry.
- The report aims to provide an evidence-based framework for States and UTs to identify logistics bottlenecks, prioritize reforms, and improve global competitiveness by reducing overall logistics costs.
- It fosters a spirit of competitive and cooperative federalism.

Key Features of the 2025 Report:

- Methodological Evolution:** LEADS 2025 (the 7th edition) features a more rigorous methodology, moving from a 3-tier to a new 4-tier performance framework to better reflect the maturity of different logistics ecosystems.
- Emphasis on Objective Indicators:** To ensure robustness, nearly 59% weightage is now assigned to measurable, objective indicators rather than purely perception-based data.
- Alignment with National Policies:** The report is tightly integrated with the PM GatiShakti National Master Plan and the National Logistics Policy (NLP).
- Assessment Parameters:** States are evaluated on Policy and Institutional Framework, Infrastructure Quality (Road, Rail, Warehouse), Reliability of Services, and Operating Environment (Safety, Ease of Entry).

The new four-tier categorization is as follows:

Tier	Definition	Top Examples (LEADS 2025)
Exemplars	The Gold Standard performers. States demonstrating sustained excellence across policy, infrastructure, and regulatory dimensions.	Coastal States: Tamil Nadu Landlocked States: Uttar Pradesh North- Eastern States: Mizoram Union Territories: Delhi
High Performers	States that demonstrate strong and consistent outcomes across the majority of performance indicators.	Coastal States: Gujarat, Kerala, Maharashtra Landlocked States: Haryana, Telangana, Chhattisgarh, Bihar North- Eastern States: Tripura, Meghalaya Union Territories: Jammu & Kashmir, Puducherry
Accelerators	States showing notable improvement momentum and a very clear <u>reform-oriented trajectory</u> in recent years.	Coastal States: Andhra Pradesh, Odisha, Goa, Karnataka Landlocked States: Punjab, Jharkhand, Madhya Pradesh, Uttarakhand, Himachal Pradesh North- Eastern States: Nagaland, Arunachal Pradesh, Manipur, Assam Union Territories: Dadra & Nagar Haveli and Daman & Diu, Chandigarh, Ladakh, Lakshadweep
Growth Seekers	States at the foundational stage of logistics system development and institutional strengthening.	Coastal States: West Bengal Landlocked States: Rajasthan North- Eastern States: Sikkim Union Territories: Andaman & Nicobar Islands

25. ANEEL fuel is primarily based on:

ANEEL ईंधन मुख्य रूप से इस पर आधारित है:

- Thorium
- Plutonium
- Graphite
- Lithium

Answer: A

'ANEEL' fuel

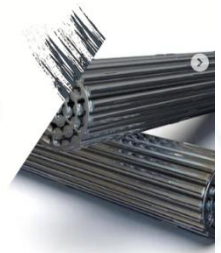
Chicago-based nuclear fuel company Clean Core Thorium Energy (CCTE) announced that its patented 'ANEEL' fuel has completed its high burnup irradiation test in an Advanced Test Reactor (ATR) at Idaho National Laboratory (INL)

- It is only the second American company to have secured an export license from the US Department of Energy (DAE) to sell nuclear technology to India in nearly two decades.
- CCTE has developed a thorium-based fuel, called ANEEL or Advanced Nuclear Energy for Enriched Life, that can be deployed in the country's Pressurised Heavy Water Reactors (PHWRs) at scale.
- ANEEL is a new type of fuel that blends thorium with HALEU (high-assay low-enriched uranium) which is an important step towards the third leg of India's 3-stage nuclear programme.
- STAGE 3 of nuclear programme: The third stage will be based on the ThU233 cycle. U233 produced in the second stage can be used for the third stage of the power programme, which consists of advanced thermal and fast breeder reactors, for long-term energy security.

ANEEL Fuel

WHY IN NEWS?

Chicago-based nuclear fuel company Clean Core Thorium Energy (CCTE) announced that its patented 'ANEEL' fuel has completed its high burnup irradiation test in an **Advanced Test Reactor (ATR)** at **Idaho National Laboratory (INL)**.



26. Qom, recently seen in news, is located in:

कोम, जो हाल ही में खबरों में रहा है, कहाँ स्थित है?

- (a) Iran
- (b) Saudi Arabia
- (c) Iraq
- (d) Syria

Answer: (A)

Qom

- Qom is home to one of the largest Indian communities in Iran with over 3,000 to 3,500 nationals, many of them students enrolled in religious seminaries and universities.
- It serves as a link between the central provinces of Iran and Tehran
- It is primarily known for its significance as the center of Shia Islamic scholarship and theology.
- The city is the site of the largest theological college in Iran and a petroleum distribution center, with petrochemical, cement, textile, and other industries.
- Qom became a center of Shi'ite Islam in the 8th century AD and a place of pilgrimage in the 17th century.



27. Governor _____ formally appointed _____ as the Chief Minister of Tamil Nadu.

गवर्नर _____ ने औपचारिक रूप से _____ को तमिलनाडु का मुख्यमंत्री नियुक्त किया।

- A. Rajendra Arlekar, C. Joseph Vijay
- B. R.N. Ravi, M.K. Stalin
- C. Banwarilal Purohit, O. Panneerselvam
- D. C.P. Radhakrishnan, Edappadi K. Palaniswami

Answer: A

Vijay takes oath as Tamil Nadu CM, the second debutant Legislator, to be sworn in as T.N. CM since 1967

- C Joseph Vijay was sworn in as Chief Minister of Tamil Nadu, with nine others taking oath as ministers for his cabinet at Jawaharlal Nehru Stadium in Chennai.
- The Governor Rajendra Arlekar had formally appointed Vijay and invited him to form the government after he crossed the majority mark with support from Congress, CPI, CPI(M), VCK, and IUML.
- The TVK managed to reach 120 seats in the 234-member Assembly.

- Tamilaga Vettri Kazhagam founder and actor C. Joseph Vijay became the second debutant Legislator to be sworn in as the Chief Minister of Tamil Nadu since 1967.
- He is also the first member of a minority religious denomination (Christian) to occupy the top post in the State.
- Chief Minister and Council of Ministers Constitutional Provisions
- The Chief Minister and the Council of Ministers, as outlined in Part VI of the Indian Constitution, form a key part of the state executive, alongside the Governor and Advocate General of State.
- The following are the constitutional provisions:
- Article 163 establishes that the Council of Ministers, headed by the Chief Minister, is responsible for aiding and advising the Governor in the exercise of most of the Governor's functions, except the discretionary ones.
- Article 164 outlines other provisions regarding the appointment, roles, and responsibilities of ministers, including the Chief Minister, within the state government.
- Article 166 deals with the conduct of the business of the state government.
- **Article 167:** Under Article 167, it is the Chief Minister's duty to inform the Governor of all decisions made by the Council of Ministers regarding state administration and legislative proposals.
- He must also provide any information the Governor requests about state affairs and legislation.
- Additionally, if required, the Chief Minister must present any matter decided by a minister but not yet reviewed by the Council of Ministers for its consideration
- **Rights of Ministers:** Article 177 grants ministers including the Chief Minister the right to speak in, and participate in the proceedings of, the legislative assemblies and councils of the state, as well as any committee of the state legislature of which they may be named a member.
- However, they do not have the right to vote unless they are members of a particular House of bicameral state legislature.
- **Chief Minister Appointment**
 - The Constitution provides no specific procedure for selecting or appointing the Chief Minister, stating only in Article 164 that the Chief Minister is appointed by the Governor.
 - While this appointment is at the Governor's discretion, the Governor traditionally appoints the leader of the majority party in the legislative assembly as Chief Minister, following parliamentary conventions.
 - **Absence of a Clear Majority:** If no party has a clear majority, the Governor may use personal discretion to appoint the leader of the largest party or coalition as Chief Minister and require a confidence vote within a month.
 - Moreover, in cases where a Chief Minister dies unexpectedly without an obvious successor, the Governor may exercise judgment in the selection, although the ruling party typically elects a new leader for appointment.
 - **Membership Criteria:** The Governor may also appoint a Chief Minister before h/she proves a majority in the assembly, granting time to do so.
 - A person not yet a member of the state legislature can be appointed as Chief Minister but must secure a legislative seat within six months to retain the position



Appointment of Council of Ministers

- **The Chief Minister advises the Governor on the appointment of the Council of Ministers, meaning the Governor can only appoint those individuals recommended by the Chief Minister. Ministers serve at the discretion of the Governor.**
- While the Council of Ministers is typically appointed from the state legislature, either the legislative assembly or council, a person who is not yet a member can also be appointed.

- However, such a minister must join either House within six months, or he/she will lose ministerial position.
- If any question arises regarding whether a matter falls within the discretionary powers, the decision made by the Governor is final, and the validity of any action taken cannot be challenged on the grounds that it should or should not have been done at the Governor's discretion.
- Furthermore, the advice given by the Ministers cannot be examined by any court.
- Chief Minister and Council of Ministers Disqualification
- The 91st Constitutional Amendment Act, 2003 stipulates that any member of the state legislature, belonging to a political party, who is disqualified due to defection, shall also be ineligible for appointment as a minister or Chief Minister.

28. The theme of the 5th BRICS SAI Leaders' Summit is:

5वें ब्रिक्स SAI नेताओं के शिखर सम्मेलन का विषय है:

- A. Digital Governance and Transparency
- B. Sustainable Finance for Growth
- C. Green Economy and Innovation
- D. Ease of Living with a Focus on Urban Mobility

Answer: d

5th BRICS SAI Leaders' Summit begins under theme "Ease of Living with Focus on Urban Mobility"



- The two-day 5th BRICS Supreme Audit Institutions (SAI) Leaders' Summit began in Bengaluru today under the theme "Ease of Living with a Focus on Urban Mobility".
- Organised by the Office of the Comptroller and Auditor General of India as part of India's BRICS Chairmanship 2026, the summit has brought together 42 delegates, including Heads of SAIs from BRICS countries.
- The summit was inaugurated by Comptroller and Auditor General of India K. Sanjay Murthy.
- Delegates from Brazil, China, Egypt, Ethiopia, India, Indonesia, Russia, South Africa, and the UAE are participating in the summit.
- The event will conclude with the adoption of the BRICS SAI Work Plan 2027-28 and the Bengaluru Declaration.

29. Consider the following statements regarding the Pro-tem Speaker:

The Pro-tem Speaker functions only during the transitional phase of a newly constituted House.

The Constitution explicitly lays down the procedure for appointment of the Pro-tem Speaker.

Conventionally, the senior-most member of the House is appointed as the Pro-tem Speaker.

Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- A. 1 and 3 only
- B. 1 only
- C. 2 and 3 only
- D. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: A

Who is a Pro-tem Speaker, and why is the role crucial for a new Assembly?

- Tamil Nadu got a new Pro-tem speaker on May 10, 2026. Tamilaga Vettri Kazhagam MLA Karuppiyah M.V. was sworn in as the Pro-tem Speaker by Governor Rajendra Vishwanath Arlekar.
- Who is a Pro-tem Speaker?
- A Pro-tem ("for the time being") Speaker is a temporary presiding officer appointed to fulfil specific constitutional and procedural requirements during the transition between two legislative assemblies.

Why is a Pro-tem Speaker appointed?

They are appointed for two primary reasons:

- **Oath-administration:** To administer the oath of office to all newly elected Members of the Legislative Assembly (MLAs) so that they can legally participate in the House proceedings.
- **Conducting elections:** To preside over the matters of the House until a permanent Speaker and Deputy Speaker are elected by the members.

How is a Pro-tem Speaker appointed?

- The senior-most member of the House (usually by number of terms served) is chosen for the role. This is not a legal rule, and the government may recommend other members, too.
- The Governor of the State appoints the Pro-tem Speaker and administers the oath of office to them.

30. India's medal tally at the Archery World Cup 2026 Stage 2 comprised:

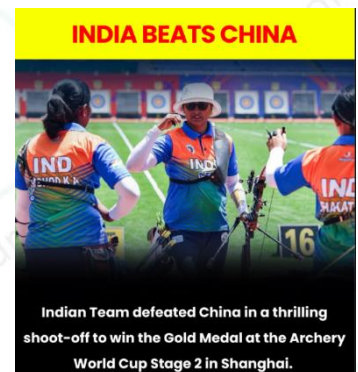
आर्चरी विश्व कप 2026 के दूसरे चरण में भारत के पदकों की संख्या इस प्रकार रही:

- One gold medal and one bronze medal
- One gold medal and one silver medal
- Two gold medals
- Two bronze medals

Answer: (a)

Archery World Cup Stage 2 2026 Results

- India concluded the Shanghai leg of the Archery World Cup 2026 series with two medals.
- India's Sahil Jadhav won a bronze medal in the men's individual compound event
- The Indian women's recurve team, comprising Deepika Kumari, Ankita Bhakat and Kumkum Mohod, won the gold medal at the Archery World Cup 2026 in Shanghai after beating hosts, the People's Republic of China,
- Stage 3 of the World Cup will be held in Antalya, Turkey, from June 9-14.
- The 2026 Archery World Cup Stage 2 took place from 5–10 May 2026 in Shanghai, China



31. Recently discovered with a thin atmosphere, (612533) 2002 XV93 belongs to which category of celestial bodies?

हाल ही में एक पतले वायुमंडल के साथ खोजा गया (612533) 2002 XV93, खगोलीय

पिंडों की किस श्रेणी से संबंधित है?

- Near-Earth Object
- Main-belt Asteroid
- Trans-Neptunian Object
- Dwarf Planet

Answer: C

Trans-Neptunian Object: 2002 XV93

- Astronomers have discovered a thin atmosphere on the trans-Neptunian object (612533) 2002 XV93, making it only the second such body after Pluto known to possess one.
- (612533) 2002 XV93 is a small, icy celestial body located in the Kuiper Belt, a vast region of the solar system beyond the orbit of Neptune.
- It is a trans-Neptunian object (TNO) that likely dates back to the dawn of the solar system, approximately 4.5 billion years ago.

Discovered By:

- The atmosphere was identified through stellar occultation—observing the object as it passed in front of a distant star—using ground-based telescopes in Japan (Kyoto, Nagano, and Fukushima).

Key Features

- **Dimensions:** It has a diameter of roughly 310 miles (500 km), making it much smaller than dwarf planets like Pluto or Eris.



- **Atmospheric Composition:** The atmosphere is extremely tenuous—roughly 5 to 10 million times thinner than Earth's.
- It is believed to be dominated by methane, nitrogen, or carbon monoxide.
- **Orbital Characteristics:** It follows an elliptical path around the Sun, completing one orbit every 247 years. Its distance from the Sun averages about 39.6 AU (3.7 billion miles).
- **Composition:** Primarily consists of water ice, rock, and organic-rich materials.

Possible Origin of Atmosphere:

- **Cryovolcanism:** Gases seeping or venting from the interior through surface cracks (internal supply).
- **Recent Impact:** Temporary gases released following a collision with another smaller object.

32. GARUDA, recently proposed by SEBI, is related to

हाल ही में सेबी द्वारा प्रस्तावित गरुड़ किससे संबंधित है?

- digital banking regulation
- green-channel approval mechanism for AIFs
- cyber security framework for stock exchanges
- regulation of cryptocurrency exchanges

Answer: B.

SEBI Proposes GARUDA Green-Channel for AIF Launches

- The Securities and Exchange Board of India (SEBI) proposed GARUDA, a green-channel mechanism for Alternative Investment Funds (AIFs).
- GARUDA stands for "Green-Channel: AIF Rollout Upon Document Acknowledgement"
- The proposal seeks to reduce the waiting period for launching regular AIF schemes from the current 30 days to 10 working days after filing the Placement Memorandum (PPM) with Sebi.
- AI-only schemes and Angel Funds may get immediate launch approvals with easier filing norms
- AIFs in India are classified into Category I, Category II and Category III, and they include venture capital funds, private equity funds, hedge funds and angel funds.



33. The 'Lion' Species Spotlight Programme was inaugurated at which national park?

‘Lion’ Species Spotlight Programme का उद्घाटन किस राष्ट्रीय उद्यान में किया गया?

- Ranthambore National Park
- Kaziranga National Park
- Gir National Park
- Bandipur National Park

Answer: (c)

Union Environment Minister inaugurates 'Lion' Species Spotlight Programme at Sasan Gir Gujarat, as a Pre-IBCA Summit Event

- Union Environment Minister Bhupender Yadav inaugurated the 'Lion' Species Spotlight Programme at Gir National Park in Sasan Gir, Gujarat, as part of the pre-summit events leading up to the International Big Cat Alliance (IBCA) Summit 2026.
- The lion population in the Greater Gir Landscape has risen to an estimated 891 individuals in 2025, dignitaries launched a 'Lion Conservation Brochure', while educational films and presentations on big cat conservation
- India will host the first-ever IBCA Summit 2026 in New Delhi on June 1 and 2 under the chairmanship of PM Modi.
- The summit, themed "Save Big Cats, Save Humanity, Save Ecosystem".



34. The theme of the 10th edition of the Indian Ocean Dialogue was:

इंडियन ओशन डायलॉग के 10वें संस्करण का विषय था:

- (a) Securing the Indo-Pacific
- (b) Indian Ocean Region in a Transforming World
- (c) Blue Economy for Sustainable Growth
- (d) Maritime Cooperation and Security

Answer: (b)

The Indian Ocean Dialogue (IOD)

- India recently hosted the tenth edition of the Indian Ocean Dialogue in New Delhi under the theme Indian Ocean Region in a Transforming World.
- The event marked a critical milestone as India assumed the Chairship of the Indian Ocean Rim Association (IORA) for the 2025–27 period.
- The Indian Ocean Dialogue is a premier Track 1.5 forum—a collaborative platform involving both government officials (Track 1) and non-governmental experts (Track 2), such as scholars, think tanks, and civil society members.
- It serves as a flagship initiative for open discussion on strategic regional issues.
- **Established In:** The dialogue originated from a decision made during the 13th Council of Ministers meeting in Perth, Australia, in November 2013.
- **The inaugural session was subsequently hosted by India in Kerala in 2014.**
- **Theme (10th Edition):** Indian Ocean Region in a Transforming World — focusing on navigating geopolitical shifts and emerging maritime challenges.
- **Multilateral Collaboration:** Organized by the Ministry of External Affairs (MEA) in partnership with the Indian Council of World Affairs (ICWA) and the IORA Secretariat.
- **Broad Participation:** Brings together senior policymakers and experts from 23 IORA Member States and 12 Dialogue Partners (including the US, China, and the EU).



35. Which country is hosting the Kimberley Process (KP) Intersessional Meeting 2026?

कौन सा देश किम्बरली प्रोसेस (KP) इंटरसेशनल मीटिंग 2026 की मेज़बानी कर रहा है?

- (a) South Africa
- (b) Belgium
- (c) India
- (d) Botswana

Answer: (c)

- India commenced the Kimberley Process (KP) Intersessional Meeting in Mumbai as the Chair for the year
- The Kimberley Process (KP) is a multi-stakeholder international initiative involving governments, the diamond industry, and civil society.
- It is the world's most comprehensive mechanism designed to increase oversight in the diamond industry and eliminate the trade in conflict diamonds.
- **Initiative Started:** May 2000 in Kimberley, South Africa.
- **Formalized:** The Kimberley Process Certification Scheme (KPCS) was adopted in November 2002 and launched in January 2003.
- **Aim:** The primary aim is to prevent conflict diamonds—rough diamonds used by rebel movements to finance wars against legitimate governments—from entering the mainstream market. It ensures that diamond purchases do not fund violence or human rights abuses.
- **Current Chair (2026):** India (assuming office on January 1, 2026). This is the third time India has held the prestigious Chairship.
- **Term:** The Chairship is rotated annually among member states.
- **India's 2026 Theme:** The 3Cs — Credibility, Compliance, and Consumer Confidence.



The Kimberley Process Certification Scheme (KPCS):

- The KPCS is the core operational instrument of the Kimberley Process, established pursuant to UN General Assembly Resolution 55/56.
- It serves as a passport for rough diamonds, providing a guarantee that they are conflict-free.

36. The report titled “Invisible Barriers: The Costs of Non-Tariff Measures” was released by:

“अदृश्य बाधाएँ: गैर-टैरिफ उपायों की लागत” शीर्षक वाली रिपोर्ट किसके द्वारा जारी की

गई थी?

- A. World Trade Organization (WTO)
- B. International Monetary Fund (IMF)
- C. United Nations Trade and Development (UNCTAD)
- D. World Bank

Answer: C

UNCTAD Flags Rising Cost of Non-Tariff Barriers

- UN Trade and Development (UNCTAD) in its ‘Invisible Barriers: The Costs of Non-Tariff Measures’ Report highlights that global trade is increasingly being shaped by regulatory restrictions, technical standards and geopolitical trade interventions.
- **Key Findings of the Report**
 - **Dominance of Non-Tariff Measures (NTMs):** NTMs now impose higher export costs than tariffs for 88% of countries.
 - **Double Burden on Developing Nations:** of both rising tariffs and heavy NTM compliance costs.
- **Modern trade negotiations:** have shifted away from simply lowering tariffs to focusing heavily on regulatory easing. E.g. EU-India Trade Deal.
- **LDCs lose approximately 10% of their exports to G20 markets as they often lack the financial resources and accredited testing facilities to navigate complex regulations.**
- **Recommendations of UNCTAD**
 - **Enhance Transparency:** It can reduce trade costs associated with non-tariff barriers by about 19 %.
 - **Fostering Regulatory Cooperation and Alignment:** Aligning domestic regulations with international standards can reduce NTM related trade costs by 15-30% without compromising safety.
 - **Boosting South-South Trade Integration:** Leveraging transparency and regulatory cooperation can strengthen trade among developing countries.
 - **Others:** Capacity-Building and Technical Support, Empowering LDCs in Trade Diplomacy etc.
 - **Examples:** Codex Alimentarius, International Plant Protection Convention (IPPC), World Organisation for Animal Health (WOAH) etc.



About UN Trade and Development (UNCTAD)

- **HQ:** Geneva, Switzerland.
- **Genesis:** Established as a permanent intergovernmental body by the United Nations General Assembly in 1964.
- **It is a part of the UN Secretariat and United Nations Development Group.**
- **Objective:** To aid developing countries, particularly the least developed ones, and transitioning economies, in integrating effectively into the global economy.
- **Members:** 195 nations (including India)
- **Key Reports:** Trade & Development report, World Investment report, Least Developed Countries report etc.

37. The theme vision of Kalam & Kavach 3.0 is represented by “JAI”, which stands for:

'कलम और कवच 3.0' की थीम विज़न को 'JAI' द्वारा दर्शाया गया है, जिसका अर्थ है:

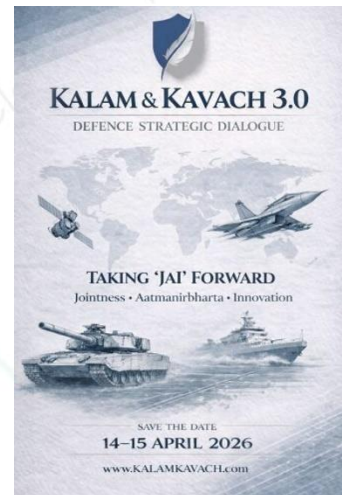
- (a) Jointness, Aatmanirbharta and Innovation
- (b) Justice, Awareness and Integrity

- (c) Joint Action and Intelligence
(d) Jobs, Advancement and Inclusion

Answer: (a)

Raksha Rajya Mantri to inaugurate Kalam & Kavach 3.0 themed 'Taking JAI Forward With I²'

- Raksha Rajya Mantri Shri Sanjay Seth inaugurated the third edition of Kalam & Kavach at Manekshaw Centre, New Delhi on May 14, 2026
- The event is centred around the strategic vision of Jointness, Aatmanirbharta and Innovation (JAI), along with emphasis on Indigenisation and International Collaboration (I²).
- The conference will serve as a premier strategic platform bringing together senior policy makers, military leadership, defence industry stakeholders, diplomats, innovators, start-ups, academia & strategic experts to deliberate on India's evolving defence transformation, indigenous capability development, and future warfighting preparedness.
- Kalam & Kavach 3.0 aims to highlight MSME participation, iDEX-driven innovation ecosystems, defence industrial corridors, indigenous production capabilities, and production scalability for achieving Viksit Bharat@2047.



38. Consider the following statements regarding Somnath Temple:

1. Mahmud Ghazni attacked the temple in the 11th century.
2. The present Somnath Temple follows the Chalukya style of architecture.
3. The Somnath pilgrimage site is associated with the confluence of the Kapila, Hiran and Saraswati rivers.

Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- A. 1 and 2 only
B. 2 and 3 only
C. 1 and 3 only
D. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: D

- For the first time in history, the sacred shores of Somnath will witness the thunder of the Indian Air Force's Suryakiran AIR show.
- The Indian Air Force's renowned Surya Kiran Aerobatic Team (SKAT) will present an air show over the Somnath Temple on May 11 as part of the 'Somnath Amrut Mahotsav-2026' celebrations marking 75 years of the temple's reconstruction, which will be attended by Prime Minister Narendra Modi,
- The show will feature the IAF's elite Suryakiran Aerobatics Team (SKAT), utilising six Hawk-MK-132 fighter jets operating out of the Jamnagar airbase.
- Flying at incredible speeds of 800 to 900 kilometers per hour, the pilots will execute a series of complex maneuvers designed to showcase the pinnacle of pilot training and combat readiness.
- Prime Minister is set to visit the iconic Somnath Temple in Gujarat to mark the 75th anniversary of the restored Hindu temple's inauguration by President Rajendra Prasad in 1951.

About Somnath Temple

- It is a Hindu temple dedicated to Lord Shiva.
- It is located in Prabhas Patan near Veraval in Saurashtra on the western coast of Gujarat.
- It is the first of the 12 jyotirlinga shrines in India that are regarded as the manifestation of the Lord Shiva Himself.
- The site of Somnath has been a pilgrimage site from ancient times on account of being a Triveni Sangam: the confluence of three rivers, namely Kapila, Hiran, and Saraswati.
- The ancient temple's timeline can be traced from 649 BC but is believed to be older than that.



39. Consider the following crops in the context of the Minimum Support Price (MSP) for Kharif Marketing Season 2026-27:

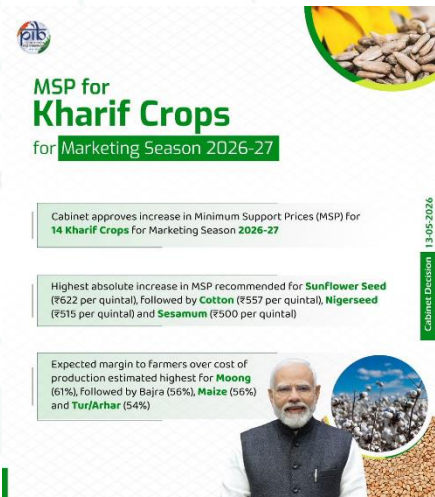
1. Moong
2. Bajra
3. Maize
4. Tur/Arhar

The expected margin to farmers over their cost of production was estimated to be more than 50% for which of the above crops?

- (a) 1 and 2 only
- (b) 1, 2 and 3 only
- (c) 1, 2, 3 and 4
- (d) 2, 3 and 4 only

Answer: c

- Cabinet approves Minimum Support Prices (MSP) for Kharif Crops for Marketing Season 2026-27
- The Cabinet Committee on Economic Affairs (CCEA) chaired by the Prime Minister Shri Narendra Modi has approved the increase in the Minimum Support Prices (MSP) for 14 Kharif Crops for Marketing Season 2026-27.
- Government has increased the MSP of Kharif Crops for Marketing Season 2026-27, to ensure remunerative prices to the growers for their produce.
- The highest absolute increase in MSP over the previous year has been recommended for Sunflower Seed (₹ 622 per quintal) followed by Cotton (Rs. 557 per quintal), Nigerseed (Rs.515 per quintal) and Sesamum (Rs.500 per quintal).
- The expected margin to farmers over their cost of production are estimated to be highest in case of Moong (61%) followed by Bajra (56%), Maize (56%) and Tur/Arhar (54%).
- For rest of the crops, margin to farmers over their cost of production is estimated to be at 50%.



Minimum Support Price (MSP)

- The Minimum Support Price (MSP) is the minimum price set by the government to ensure farmers receive fair value for their crops, even when market prices fall.
- This concept was introduced in 1966-67 during the Green Revolution as part of agricultural reforms, MSP serves as a safety measure taken by the union government to protect farmers from financial losses and maintain food security.
- The Indian government announces MSP twice a year, before the Kharif (monsoon) and Rabi (winter) sowing seasons.
- The Commission for Agricultural Costs and Prices (CACP) recommends the MSP, which is then approved by the Cabinet Committee on Economic Affairs (CCEA).

S. No	Cropping Season	Time Period	Crops	States
1.	Rabi	Sown: October-December Harvested: April-June	Wheat, barley, peas, gram, mustard etc.	Punjab, Haryana, Himachal Pradesh, Jammu and Kashmir, Uttarakhand and Uttar Pradesh
2.	Kharif	Sown: June-July Harvested: September-October	Rice, maize, jowar, bajra, tur, moong, urad, cotton, jute, groundnut, soybean etc.	Assam, West Bengal, coastal regions of Odisha, Andhra Pradesh, Telangana, Tamil Nadu, Kerala and Maharashtra
3.	Zaid	Sown and harvested: March-July (between Rabi and Kharif)	Seasonal fruits, vegetables, fodder crops etc.	Most of the northern and northwestern states

40. SEHAT Mission primarily seeks to strengthen the linkage between :

SEHAT मिशन मुख्य रूप से इनके बीच के जुड़ाव को मज़बूत करना चाहता है:

- A. industrial growth and foreign trade
- B. agricultural transformation and public health outcomes
- C. defence production and food security
- D. climate finance and renewable energy

Answer: B

ICMR, ICAR Launch SEHAT Initiative

- Recently, the Union Minister for Health and Family Welfare and Union Minister for Agriculture and Farmers' Welfare launched the 'SEHAT Mission' in Delhi.
- SEHAT (Science Excellence for Health through Agricultural Transformation) is a national mission-mode programme designed to translate agricultural advancements into tangible health outcomes for the people of India.
- It has been jointly launched by the Indian Council of Agricultural Research (ICAR) and the Indian Council of Medical Research (ICMR).
- Objective: Launched with the objective of building a framework for 'Healthy Food, Healthy Farms and a Healthy India'.
- It strategically align agricultural research and innovation with national priorities in nutrition, preventive and promotive healthcare, non-communicable diseases, farmer well-being, and One Health.



Important Headlines

- Shri Amit Shah, releases Solicitor General Shri Tushar Mehta's book 'The Bench, the Bar, and the Bizarre' and 'the Lawful and the Awful' in New Delhi
- The English version of the book 'The folk festival of Ganga Jatara in Tirupati' was released on the final day of the nine-day annual "Gangamma Jatara"
- President Yoweri Museveni Sworn In for Historic Seventh Term in Uganda
- Péter Magyar, Hungary's new prime minister
- Jayen Mehta was unanimously elected as the first chairman of the Sardar Patel Cooperative Dairy Federation Limited (SPCDF).
- The Government appointed Vice Admiral Krishna Swaminathan as the next Chief of the Naval Staff.
- The Karnataka government has finally appointed retired Karnataka High Court judge Ramachandra D. Huddar as chairperson for the Admission Overseeing Committee (AOC) for professional courses.
- Kuljeet Kaur Marhas has become the first Indian woman to be elected Fellow of The Meteoritical Society(HQ :USA), one of the world's most prestigious honours in meteoritics and planetary science.
- An Indian-origin transgender candidate Q Manivannan has been elected to the Scottish Parliament despite not having permanent UK residency.
- Professor Susan Elias, a computer scientist and academic administrator, is set to become the St Stephen's college's first woman principal from June 1. She succeeds Professor John Varghese.
- The Junior men's team, Hockey India named Frenchman and former France and Spain coach Frederic Soye as his successor.
- Union Home Minister and Minister of Cooperation Amit Shah addressed the President's Colour Award Ceremony of the National Disaster Response Force in Ghaziabad as the Chief Guest.
- BAFTA has announced the winners of the 2026 BAFTA Television Awards with P&O Cruises at a ceremony in London

Category	Winner
Drama series	Code Of Silence (ITV1)

Limited drama	Adolescence (Netflix)
Leading actor	Stephen Graham - Adolescence (Netflix)
Leading actress	Narges Rashidi - Prisoner 951 (BBC One)
Supporting actor	Owen Cooper - Adolescence (Netflix)

- The President of India, Smt Droupadi Murmu presented the National Florence Nightingale Awards for the year 2026 to the nursing personnel, A total of 15 awards are given in the category of Registered Auxiliary Nurses & Midwife, Registered Nurses and Midwife and Registered Lady Visitor.
- Prateek Yadav, son of late Samajwadi Party founder Mulayam Singh Yadav, died at the age of 38 years in Lucknow.
- Former Kerala Director General of Police (DGP) P.J. Alexander passed away , He was 92
- Karnataka Planning and Statistics Minister D Sudhakar died at the age of 66.
- The Ministry of Education will organise Bharatiya Bhasha Summer Camp 2026 in all schools across the country during summer vacation.
- The Supreme Court urged the Supreme Court Bar Association (SCBA) to consider creating a permanent vice-president (VP) post for women from 2027 onwards, adding that the post of secretary remain reserved for women in the upcoming Supreme Court Bar Association (SCBA) elections.
- The Prime Minister's Employment Generation Programme (PMEGP) has facilitated the establishment of more than 4 lakh micro-enterprises and generated employment for over 36 lakh people during the 15th Finance Commission cycle.
- Bureau of Indian Standards (BIS), the National Standards Body of India, organised the 35th Plenary and Working Groups meetings of the ISO TC 20 / SC 14 'Space Systems and Operations' subcommittee of International Organisation for Standardisation (ISO) at New Delhi.
- The silver jubilee celebrations marking 25 years of the Pradhan Mantri Gram Sadak Yojana (PMGSY) and the national launch of PMGSY-IV held in Bhairunda of Madhya Pradesh's Sehore district.
- Recently, the Government of India has launched the Swasth Bharat Portal. It is a unified platform designed to integrate fragmented health programme systems across the country.
- Union Minister of State (Independent Charge) for Science & Technology and Earth Sciences, and MoS PMO, Personnel, Public Grievances, Pensions, Atomic Energy and Space, Dr. Jitendra Singh chaired a high-level review meeting on preparations for the forthcoming "Swachh Sagar, Surakshit Sagar" (SSSS) campaign and separately assessed arrangements for the upcoming India International Science Festival.
- Recently, the Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology (MeitY), Government of India launched IP Catalyst initiative along with its digital platform.
- The three flagship Jan Suraksha Schemes—Pradhan Mantri Jeevan Jyoti Bima Yojana (PMJJBY), Pradhan Mantri Suraksha Bima Yojana (PMSBY), and Atal Pension Yojana (APY)—completed 11 years of providing affordable social security.
- The Supreme Court in May 2026 held that the statutory bar under Section 18 of the Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes (Prevention of Atrocities) Act, 1989, cannot be applied mechanically to deny anticipatory bail.
- The Department of Financial Services (DFS) formally inaugurated India's domestic insurance pool, that is, the Bharat Maritime Insurance Pool (BMIP) which holds a sovereign guarantee of ₹12,980 crore that seeks to accord a continuous stream of maritime insurance coverages.
- Recently, the Directorate General of Foreign Trade (DGFT) prohibited export of raw, white and refined sugar with immediate effect till September 30 amid the ongoing West Asia conflict.
- The Government of India and the International Fund for Agricultural Development (IFAD) launched a new eight-year Country Strategic Opportunities Programme (COSOP) for the period 2026–2033.
- Union Minister for Road, Transport and Highways Nitin Gadkari on inaugurated Multi-Lane Free Flow (MLFF) barrier-less tolling system at the Mundka-Bakkarwala Toll Plaza on Urban Extension Road-II (UER-II).

- The Central Board of Secondary Education (CBSE) in collaboration with the All India Institute of Medical Sciences (AIIMS) organised the Mind Activation Through Education MATE Counselors' Conclave in New Delhi.
- Raksha Rajya Mantri to inaugurate India's first International Ophthalmology Research Conference in New Delhi
- Uttar Pradesh Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath launched the first phase of Census-2027 under the theme "Hamari Janaganana, Hamara Vikas", formally beginning house listing and housing census operations at a programme
- Union Minister of State Jitendra Singh visited the Banaras Hindu University (BHU) and inspected the interdisciplinary facility "SATHI" set up with the support of Department of Science & Technology, Govt of India.
- The Bihar Cabinet approved a 2% increase in Dearness Allowance (DA) for State government employees, pensioners and family pensioners getting revised salary or pension as per the 7th Pay Commission recommendations.
- 13 children belonging to the Baiga tribe, a Particularly Vulnerable Tribal Group, were recently rescued from bonded labour in Chhattisgarh's Kabirdham district.
- Odisha is set to adopt a customised version of the Kerala Warnings, Crisis and Hazard Management system (KaWaCHaM), the State's technologically advanced Early Warning Dissemination System (EWDS), to strengthen disaster preparedness along the cyclone-prone coastline of Odisha.
- Bharatiya Janata Party leader Suwendu Adhikari was sworn in as the Chief Minister of West Bengal
- Senior Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP) leader and MLA from Maniktala, Tapas Roy, took oath as the Pro-Tem speaker of the West Bengal Assembly. Governor R.N. Ravi administered the oath to Mr. Roy at the Lok Bhavan
- Himanta Biswa Sarma was sworn in as the Chief Minister of Assam for the second consecutive term , Governor Lakshman Prasad Acharya administered the oath of office to Mr. Sarma.
- Union Minister for Ports, Shipping and Waterways Sarbananda Sonowal laid the foundation stones for India's first riverine lighthouses along the Brahmaputra River on National Waterway-2 in Assam.
- Rajasthan's breast milk donation programme includes the Mother Milk Bank at Barmer District Hospital, the state-run human milk bank Jeevan Dhara in Jaipur, and the Yashoda programme under the Norway-India Partnership Initiative.
- The Cabinet Committee on Economic Affairs approved a semi high-speed double line rail project linking Sarkhej in Ahmedabad to Dholera, which lies about 100 km away, for a total cost of approximately ₹20,667 crore.
- The Union Cabinet approved the upgradation of the Nagpur International Airport through a public-private partnership.
- The Sabarmati River in Ahmedabad city remains dry after authorities of the Vasna barrage halted water flow for repair works of its gates, causing inconvenience to many.
- Maharashtra approved the Compressed Biogas (CBG) Policy, 2026, on 22 April 2026, and the policy was officially released on 5 May 2026.
- The Archaeological Survey of India (ASI) completed the 42-year-long restoration of the 12th-century dance pavilion (Kalyana Mandapam) at the Thousand Pillar Temple in Hanamkonda, Telangana.
- Prime Minister Narendra Modi inaugurated and laid the foundation stone of multiple infrastructure and industrial projects worth around Rs 9,400 crore at Hyderabad in Telangana.
- Telangana Women Safety Wing intensifies 'Stand With Her' campaign against harassment
- Tamil Nadu got a new Pro-tem speaker on May 10, 2026. Tamilaga Vettri Kazhagam MLA Karuppiyah M.V. was sworn in as the Pro-tem Speaker by Governor Rajendra Vishwanath Arlekar.
- TVK legislator J.C.D. Prabhakar was unanimously elected as the Speaker of the Tamil Nadu Assembly.
- The Tamil Nadu government has ordered the formation of the "Singappen Special Task Force" to strengthen women's safety and preventive protection measures in the state.

- India's maritime sector received a major boost with the signing of a landmark tripartite Memorandum of Understanding (MoU) for the development of the country's first mega greenfield shipyard at Thoothukudi in Tamil Nadu.
- The Tamil Nadu government under Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay, announced a 2% increase in Dearness Allowance (DA) for State government employees and teachers with retrospective effect from January 1, 2026.
- President Droupadi Murmu has appointed N Rangasamy as Chief Minister of Puducherry.
- Türkiye has unveiled a prototype of an intercontinental ballistic missile (ICBM) named Yildirimhan Missile
- India has conducted the maiden test of a nuclear-capable intercontinental ballistic missile (ICBM) off the Odisha coast.
- India conducted a successful Flight trial of an Advanced Agni missile with MIRV (Multiple Independently Targeted Re-Entry Vehicle) system from Dr APJ Abdul Kalam Island in Odisha
- The Indian Air Force (IAF) conducted an 88 hours "Op Sindoor Commemorative Run" from 07 May to 10 May 26 at New Delhi.
- Recently, the INS Sagardhwani visited Cam Ranh, Vietnam which marked a significant step in India's scientific cooperation with Vietnam
- The Indian Coast Guard conducted the girder laying ceremony for the fourth, fifth and sixth Air Cushion Vehicles (ACVs) being built for the force at the Rassaim Yard of Chowgule Shipyard in Goa.
- President Donald Trump's plan to put weapons in space — pitched as a "Golden Dome for America" missile defence program — is estimated to cost \$1.2 trillion over a 20-year period.
- Recently, NASA's Psyche spacecraft captured a stunning crescent image of Mars from nearly 5 million kilometres away.
- Astronomers have discovered a thin atmosphere on the trans-Neptunian object (612533) 2002 XV93, making it only the second such body after Pluto known to possess one.
- The James Webb Space Telescope (JWST) directly studied the rocky exoplanet LHS 3844 b, also called Kua'kua.
- A 37-year-old Indian tech professional based in California recently died after battling Valley fever, a rare fungal infection that damaged his lungs and led to respiratory failure.
- Union Minister launched two path-breaking AI-enabled weather forecasting products developed by the Ministry of Earth Sciences.
- The Tribal Council of Little and Great Nicobar has called for the revocation of three newly notified wildlife sanctuaries on the Little Nicobar, Menchal, and Meroe islands
- A couple of new lotus varieties developed -- Mayoore and Paneer Rose -- have now received registration from the Protection of Plant Varieties and Farmers' Rights Authority of the Government of India.
- Madhya Pradesh Chief Minister will release two cheetahs into the wild at Kuno National Park.
- India's first mangrove park, which has been constructed at Gorai in Mumbai's western suburbs and has been awaiting opening for nearly a year, is set to be named after former prime minister Atal Bihari Vajpayee.
- A THDC India Ltd proposal seeking clearance for the Kalai-II hydroelectric project in Arunachal Pradesh does not make any mention of the habitat of the critically endangered White-Bellied Heron.
- For the first time in nearly two decades, a tiger has been captured by camera traps in Arunachal Pradesh's D'Ering Memorial Wildlife Sanctuary
- Recently, scientists have recorded that a new invasive buff tip moth is threatening Ladakh's farm-based economy
- Recently, the Sheri Kashmir University of Agriculture and Sciences (SKUAST) in Srinagar has cultivated the Morchella mushroom for the first time in controlled condition.
- Recently, for the first time in Delhi-National Capital Region (NCR) and Haryana, a rusty-spotted cat has been photographed.
- Researchers recently recorded a new snapper species 'Lutjanus arakan' in Indian waters for the first time at Gopalpur in Ganjam district, in a significant contribution to Indian marine fish taxonomy.

- The Agricultural and Processed Food Products Export Development Authority (APEDA) facilitated the first-ever export of 20 Metric Tons of ODOP honey from Assam's Aspirational District, Baksa, to the USA.
- Recently, the Union Agriculture Ministry constituted a special expert task force to study the damage caused to litchi crops by the litchi stink bug.
- Recently, the Indian Biogas Association (IBA) has called for 10% mandatory blending of fermented organic manure with chemical fertilizers by 2030.
- A new United Nations assessment titled Global Forest Goals Report 2026 warned that rising demand for fuelwood and charcoal has emerged as a major driver of global forest degradation, particularly in Africa and parts of Asia.
- India has emerged as the world's 3rd largest country in installed renewable energy capacity, reflecting rapid growth in solar and wind power generation.
- The United States wants to make hiring foreign workers under the H-1 B visa programme significantly more expensive.
- India will host the Fourth India-Africa Forum Summit (IAFS-IV) in New Delhi from 28 May to 31 May 2026
- Canada's Bill C-22, formally called the Supporting Authorized Access to Information Act (SAAIA), is a proposed law under debate in the House of Commons in 2026.
- The IUCN Council approved the admission of 48 new members globally, including five organizations from the Mexico, Central America, and Caribbean region.
- A new report revealed that the Yavarí-Tapiche Territorial Corridor—home to the world's largest population of isolated Indigenous Peoples—is under imminent threat from oil expansion, logging, and organized crime.
- Oman's strategically located Sohar and Salalah Indian Ocean ports are facilitating vital food exports from India to six GCC nations.
- Pakistan Prime Minister Shehbaz Sharif has announced that May 10 will be celebrated as 'Marka-e-Haq Day' annually.
- Recently, UN-Habitat launched the Catalogue of Solutions 2026-2029.
- Recently, India and Brazil agreed to significantly expand their existing trade agreement between India and the MERCOSUR bloc.
- **New York:** External Affairs Minister Dr. S. Jaishankar inaugurated a special exhibition titled 'From Shunya to Ananta' at the United Nations headquarters
- Barcelona secured their 29th Spanish league title after beating Real Madrid 2-0 in El Clasico .
- Team SERSA emerged as the champions of the DRM Cup Table Tennis Tournament 2026, which concluded at the Railway Indoor Stadium
- At the Senior Open Ranking Wrestling Tournament 2026 held at Nandini Nagar Mahavidyalaya campus in Gonda, Uttar Pradesh, Sandeep of Rohtak won the Greco-Roman 60 kg title.
- India is set to host the prestigious 2026 Asian Weightlifting Championships in Gandhinagar, Gujarat from 11th May, marking the country's first time hosting the event in 44 years. The championship will conclude on the 17th of this month.
- The Sports Authority of India and MyBharat Launches Nationwide Engagement Initiatives Ahead of Commonwealth Games

QUESTION OF THE DAY

Prashant Pise has been appointed as the next Ambassador of India to :

प्रशांत पिसे को भारत का अगला राजदूत नियुक्त किया गया है :

- A. Qatar
- B. United Arab Emirates
- C. Oman
- D. Bahrain

